Lawson Wright

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EDUCATION

Tennessee State University (ABET Accredited) Nashville, TN
Master of Science in Computer Science, Cybersecurity and Networking **GPA: 3.77** Expected May 2028

Tennessee State University (ABET Accredited) Nashville, TN
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, **GPA: 3.69** Graduated

CERTIFICATIONS AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Certification: CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)
Languages and Automation: Python, Java, PHP, JavaScript, SQL, Bash, PowerShell, pandas, Scapy, pytest, JUnit 5
Secure Development and Access Control: Secure code development, Spring Security, method-level authorization, RBAC, least privilege, separation of duties, row-level security (RLS), BCrypt, audit logging, IAM, OWASP Top 10
Application Security Testing: SAST (CodeQL), SCA (Dependabot, OWASP Dependency-Check)
Detection and Response: Threat detection, security monitoring, alert triage, incident investigation, MITRE ATT&CK, Windows security events, PCAP analysis, Wireshark, root cause analysis
Security Controls and Frameworks: NIST SP 800-53 (control mapping), NIST CSF, vulnerability assessment, risk management
Systems and Tools: Linux, Windows, TCP/IP, VLANs, Cisco IOS, Spring Boot, SQLite, PostgreSQL, Git/GitHub, Jira, Confluence, Agile (Scrum)

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS AND RESEARCH

Secure Employee Management System (SEMS) Personal Cybersecurity Project
Tech Stack: Java 25, Spring Boot, Spring Security, SQLite, Maven, JUnit 5 Nov. 2026 – Present

- Enforced least-privilege access for 3 roles (Admin, Manager, Employee) with URL rules plus method-level @PreAuthorize, salted BCrypt hashing, generic login errors that prevent account enumeration, and CSRF protection, addressing OWASP Top 10 broken access control and authentication failures.
- Implemented account lockout (5 failures, 15 minutes, NIST AC-7) and separation of duties in the leave workflow (no self-approval, no re-deciding), with an admin-only audit log that excludes passwords and session IDs.
- Authored a STRIDE threat model mapping 13 threats to NIST SP 800-53 controls and documenting known gaps; wrote 41 JUnit 5 tests (0 failures) covering authentication, RBAC, lockout, workflow rules, and audit logging.
- Ran SAST (CodeQL) and SCA (Dependabot, OWASP Dependency-Check) against SEMS; remediated a High-severity regex denial-of-service finding and cut dependency CVEs from 61 to 34 through version overrides, documenting the remainder in the threat model.

NetWatch – Network Traffic & System Event Monitoring Personal Cybersecurity Project
Technologies: Python, Scapy, SQLite, pandas, Streamlit Oct. 2026 – Present

- Built a 5-page Streamlit analyst dashboard that correlates up to 100,000 packets of PCAP/PCAPNG traffic with Windows events from 4 log channels (Security, System, Application, Sysmon), producing evidence-linked alerts with triage status and related-row investigation.
- Engineered 3 tunable detection rules (5 failed logons in 300 s, 15 distinct SYN ports in 60 s, 3x volume spike) plus user-defined watch rules, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK T1110.001 and T1046. Validated them with 58 pytest tests against seeded sets of 800 packets and 80 events (8 failed logons), and documented detection gaps in a STRIDE threat model.

Software Supply Chain Security Research Tennessee State University
Focus: Vulnerability Analysis, Threat Detection, AI Security Risks Sept. 2026 – Present

- Analyzed Log4Shell (CVE-2021-44228, CVSS 10.0) and SolarWinds (2020), comparing a widely embedded library flaw with a build-pipeline compromise to assess the impact of third-party dependency and software integrity risk.
- Evaluated AI-related security risks and presented findings and risk implications in written summaries and presentations.

WORK EXPERIENCE

BECO Holdings Incorporated – Remote Nashville, TN
Software Engineer Intern Jul. 2026 – Present

- Executed 20+ security-focused test cases on Stripe payment processing and database RLS policies, validating unauthorized-access prevention, duplicate-transaction handling, refunds, and transaction integrity.
- Verified access controls and secure payment workflows through end-to-end testing across mobile apps, Stripe, and backend databases.
- Developed and maintained full-stack PHP applications for 3 government, healthcare, and education clients.

The Blount Group LLC – Remote Memphis, TN
Technology Systems and Automation Intern Jan. 2026 – Jul. 2026

- Integrated and tested AI-driven automation workflows and agents, identifying gains in reliability, efficiency, and scalability.
- Built a full-stack PHP website via cPanel for a health and life insurance agency, delivering frontend and backend functionality.

American Honda Motor Company, Incorporated Torrance, CA
Mobile Web and Product Development Co-op Jun. 2025 – Aug. 2025

- Identified and escalated delivery risks on a ROAM board during PI Planning for an Agile (Scrum) team, supporting risk-based planning.
- Documented user stories in Confluence, tracked work in Jira, and validated the mobile app against Figma designs with QA.

Music City Center Nashville, TN
Network Technician I Jul. 2024 – May 2025

- Configured, maintained, and troubleshot 50 enterprise Cisco switches plus routers across 3 VLANs, supporting 50+ events.
- Resolved 20+ network tickets and outages per week through root cause analysis of TCP/IP, port, and protocol faults.